



Camp Administrators Guide for Inclusion of Campers with Disabilities

Ruderman Chabad Inclusion Initiative

*Some of the materials were adapted from the
Foundation for Jewish Camps
Inclusion Training Manual*

<http://www.jewishcamp.org/knowledgecenter>

and

www.EyeonBullying.com

Camp Administrators Inclusion Guide

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Introduction

What is RCII?

The Ruderman-Chabad Inclusion Initiative (RCII) is dedicated to building on the philosophy and mission of Chabad Lubavitch by providing Chabad communities around the globe with the education and resources they need to support people with disabilities and advance inclusion efforts. RCII engages Chabad's network of human and educational resources to create a Culture of Inclusion so that all Jews—including those with disabilities--feel welcomed, supported, and valued.

What is Inclusion?

- Inclusion is an attitude that honors and values every human being, without regard to ability.
- Inclusion is a process -- not an event or a special program.
- Inclusion means creating an environment in which the community goes beyond welcoming people with disabilities by asking how those individuals want to participate in every aspect of community life.
- Inclusion means that we do not do things *for* people with disabilities. Rather, we do things *with* people with disabilities.
- Inclusion happens when we change our mindsets and understand how to adapt so that someone with a disability can participate.

A Vital Part of Chabad's Mission

The discussion surrounding inclusion begins with an understanding that we are not the ones to include another. Judaism has already done that for us. The Torah says "*Ki Karov Eilecha Hadavar Me'od*" -- "This Judaism is so very close to you." Our role as a community is only to offer all Jews the opportunity to participate in their *own* Judaism. Furthermore, the Jewish people are likened to the letters of the *Sefer* Torah. Just as a *Sefer* Torah is not apt for use and cannot be considered whole if there is even one letter missing, so too each community is responsible to create an environment where every single Jew is included.

The Lubavitcher Rebbe (O'bm) did not like to use words that separated people, such as the popular term, '*Kiruv Rechokim*,' which means to bring close those that are far. "This verbiage implies that one Jew can be closer to Judaism than another," said the Rebbe, "and all Jews are connected to G-d equally." With these tenets at our very core, Chabad philosophy *already* embodies a culture of inclusion towards each and every Jew spiritually - to their *neschama*, their Jewish souls. Every one is unique and has a vital role that only he or she can fulfill in this world.

'Disability Inclusion' is first and foremost an extension of these principles as well as a deeper understanding of obstacles to meaningful participation, and requires the tools to empower people with disabilities to take part in all activities.

Why Inclusion at Camp is Important

Summer camp is a remarkable place for children to learn to work and play together in a relaxed environment. Unlike school where the focus is on academic learning, inclusive camps can increase independence, resourcefulness and social skills. There are opportunities for campers with and without disabilities to develop friendships, lifelong social skills and participate in activities together. The focus of the camp environment lends itself to fun and social experiences and is a great point of entry for inclusive community programming and experiences.

Inclusive camps highlight the similarities that exist among all children who participate. Children with disabilities have shown improvements in their self-esteem, self-reliance, and communication skills as a result of their experiences in an inclusive camp setting (Brannan, Arick, Fullerton, & Harris, 2000). Such camps also give children with disabilities the opportunity to interact with their typical peers outside of the school settings, where research has consistently found that children with disabilities often experience social rejection or isolation (Sale & Carey, 1995; Heiman, 2000; Cutts & Sigafos, 2001; Frederickson & Furnham, 2004).

Inclusive camps can also provide campers and staff without disabilities the opportunity to develop a more realistic understanding and appreciation of what it means to be a person with a disability (Mulvihill, Cotton, & Gyaben, 2004). This fosters an environment where all campers are valued, appreciated for who they are, and have opportunities to participate together in common interests and activities.

An Inclusive and Welcoming Camp Experience for All

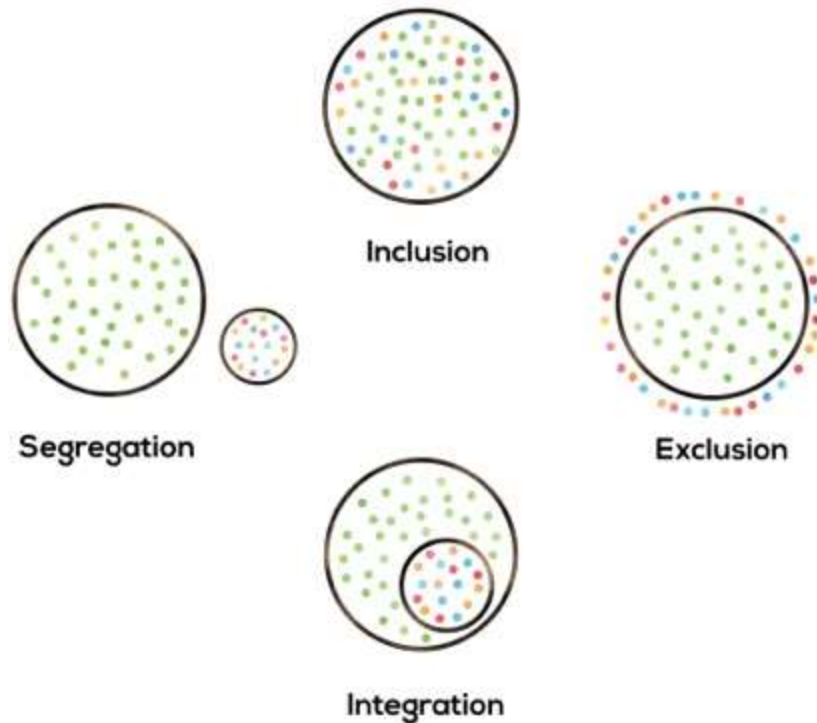
The Ruderman Chabad Inclusion Initiative (RCII) provides the Camp Resource Hub to guide you in a variety of ways that foster an inclusive culture, where all campers are valued and appreciated for their gifts, talents and skills. The Camp Resource Hub provides best practices, training manuals, webinars, communication strategies and a variety of resources that can help you work with counselors and camp staff, all campers and parents. We will be adding new resources to this page so check back often!

Inclusion is not providing *separate* bunks and programs to children within a “regular” camp. Parents may choose to send their children to a camp or program that separates them from the rest of the camp. That is a personal decision based on what each parent considers appropriate for his or her own child. Our intent with the RCII is to empower camps to support campers with disabilities as participants in all possible activities. The Camp Resource Hub provides information and strategies that will help you achieve this outcome.

What is an Inclusive Camp?

Where is your camp on this inclusion map?

What is inclusion?



An inclusive camp is one where all campers, regardless of disability, have the opportunity to be part of all activities. Inclusive camps recognize that each one of us is unique. We have different strengths, gifts and ways to contribute to our camp community. We also have unique needs based on many different factors. Each of these different needs must be supported so that every camper can maximize their potential. This does not mean that all campers are given the same supports. It does mean that each camper is given the individual supports needed in order to participate.

What is a Disability?

The Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) defines a person with a disability as one who has a physical or mental impairment that substantially limits one or more major life activities, *a person who has a history or record of such an impairment, or a person who is perceived by others as having such an impairment.*

According to this definition, a disability is defined by anything that substantially limits any major life activity such as hearing, vision, movement, learning, thinking, processing, mental health, and social relationships. This can include disabilities such as attention deficit hyperactivity disorder, learning disabilities, peanut and other food allergies, cancer, anxiety disorder, depression, traumatic brain injury, autism, cerebral palsy, vision and hearing loss and so many more.

However, just because someone has a disability does not mean they are limited in the performance of daily life activities.

Americans with Disabilities Act

*Adapted from "That All May Worship" a publication of
American Association for People with Disabilities (AAPD)*

The Language of the Law

The Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA), signed into law by President George H.W. Bush on July 26, 1990, raises to new heights the American commitment to equal opportunity for all citizens. By this legislation, individuals with disabilities are guaranteed that employment or promotion will not be denied because of their disabilities, if they are otherwise qualified. The law also promises accessibility to transportation services and public accommodations such as restaurants, museums, libraries, daycare centers, doctors' offices, hotels, private schools, retail stores and parks.

Churches, synagogues, mosques and other religious organizations or entities controlled by religious organizations are exempt from the ADA, except for the employment provisions. However, if a religious organization rents space to programs funded in part or in whole by state or federal dollars, the funded program will be required to conform to other nondiscrimination laws. If a congregation rents space to an independent daycare center, the daycare center is required to comply with the ADA.

Are All Disabilities Visible or Obvious?

No. Often people think the term “disability” only refers to people who use a wheelchair or walker. On the contrary, the 1994-1995 Survey of Income and Program Participation (SIPP) found that 26 million Americans (almost 1 in 10) were considered to have a severe disability, while only 1.8 million used a wheelchair and 5.2 million used a cane, crutches or walker (Americans with Disabilities 94-95).



Some people have disabilities that are not apparent such as learning disabilities, attention deficit hyperactivity disorder, depression, allergies and anxiety, etc. However, those types of disabilities may substantially limit any major life activity.

No two children with the same diagnosis have the same needs. Diagnoses provide general information about how someone experiences the world. For example, the National Association of Special Educators writes, “knowing that a child has a learning disability tells you only that the child is experiencing some difficulty processing information. You must learn much more about the child before you can determine how much difficulty, the type of difficulties, and/or the impact the disability has on specific academic subjects or tasks.”

<https://www.naset.org/2522.0.html>

Each person will have different needs for accommodation. For example, if a child is deaf, she may be fluent in American Sign Language (ASL). In order for her to participate inclusively, she would require an ASL interpreter. If a second child is also deaf, he may have a cochlear implant and can hear. A third child who is deaf may use cued speech or can read lips. She may not know ASL; so providing an interpreter for her based on her diagnosis would not be useful at all.

Most important is to learn about the camper from parents and service providers such as teachers, doctors, psychologists, social workers, etc. to learn what works and what does not work for that particular child.

Person-First Language

The Power of Language and Labels

The language we use to describe someone can impact our perceptions about that person. Most self-advocates (people who live with disability) prefer to put the person first, rather than the disability. Person-first language is a philosophy of putting individuals before their disabilities and goes deeper than just language. Language gives us a deep understanding of our attitudes toward people with disabilities. For example, when we cite a person's diagnostic label first, "Down syndrome child" rather than "child with Down syndrome" we are identifying them by a diagnostic label. We do not consider the strengths, gifts, interests, abilities, and commonalities we have with this person. We see them first by a series of perceived deficits based on the label.

- **Bypass condescending euphemisms.**
- **Terms such as *special*, *handicapable*, *differently abled* and *challenged* reinforce the idea that people cannot deal honestly with their disabilities. While *special* is used in the names of some educational programs and organizations, the use of *special needs* is offensive to many adults with disabilities, who want to be treated like everyone else in their community.**
- ***Special* also implies a paternalistic need to be taken care of, which is frequently not true. Just say *children with disabilities*.**

Disability is Natural by Kathie Snow provides a comprehensive list of appropriate language to talk about people who have disabilities.

<http://www.disabilityisnatural.com/images/PDF/pfl09.pdf>

Identity First Language

Some people do not believe that their disability can be separated from their identity. Members of the Deaf community, and many Autistic self-advocates prefer to be known by their disability identity. When in doubt, ask.

For one person's perspective on Identity First Language, click here.

<http://www.autistichoya.com/2011/08/significance-of-semantics-person-first.html>

Out-dated Language

Language usage changes over time. For instance, at one time the term “mental retardation” was used to describe a set of criteria that identified someone with an IQ below 70. Today, we use the term “intellectual disability.”

We have compiled a set of terms that are outdated and the terms that are currently used to describe the many different facets of living with a disability, which you can find, on the following page.

People sometimes use outdated terms once used to describe a person with a disability to denigrate or insult. For example, the term “retard” or “retarded” is used to put someone down. If you hear anyone using disability terms to insult or hurt, please stop and discuss why those words are hurtful.

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Person First Language

Person First Language puts the person before the disability. It does not make the disability the first thing we know about that person. It simply tells us that the person lives with a disability or uses a mobility device such as a wheelchair. Person First Language eliminates stereotypes and judgments about people who have disabilities. The language we use to describe a person who lives with a disability can shape our attitudes and perceptions about them.

Say This	Instead of
Sue has a disability	Sue is disabled, handicapped or differently abled
Jason uses a wheelchair	Jason is wheelchair bound, confined to a wheelchair
David has Down Syndrome	David is a Downs kid
Aaron has an intellectual disability	Aaron is retarded or slow
Bridget has a physical disability	Bridget is crippled or physically challenged/disabled
Mark is hard of hearing	Mark is hearing impaired
Laura has a vision impairment	Laura is visually impaired
Toby has cerebral palsy	Toby is a victim of or stricken with cerebral palsy
Ann has a traumatic brain injury	Ann is brain damaged
Cheryl is unable to speak, uses a communication device	Cheryl is dumb or mute
People without disabilities	Normal, healthy, typical people

Disability VS. Special Needs: Although some organizations and educational programs use the term "special needs," many people in the disability community feel that it generates pity and patronization and perpetuates the idea that people with disabilities require special care, special programs or special services which is often not true. The term disability is viewed as being non-judgmental and factual without promoting notions of pity or heroism. The term "disability" is currently the preferred terminology and is a more authentic description without any judgment attached to it - positive or negative.

Bottom Line: The evolution of language is constantly changing and being reevaluated. The bottom line is not to define a person by their disability unless that is how they choose to be defined. When in doubt, just ask.

Preparing for a Great Camp Experience

What are the components that go into making camp a success for campers with disabilities, their peers and staff? What are the things you can do before that camper even gets off the bus the first day?

This section will provide you with specific areas on which to focus. Communicating with parents in advance of camp and providing natural and appropriate supports based on information gathering and collaboration, training staff, setting up bunks and determining how to manage issues when they arise will set the stage for increased success.

Post Your Inclusion Statement

Reiterate your commitment to inclusion of all children in your communications with parents. The inclusion statement on your camp brochure should also be placed on the form requesting information about each child. The more parents see the message, the more they will be reminded that their child is warmly welcomed and that the camp staff is committed to a productive partnership with them.

Think about what your statement conveys. Keep it simple. These are two examples:

“Inclusion is the opportunity for children with and without disabilities to participate together at camp. Inclusion benefits everyone. Please help us ensure a meaningful and fun experience for your child by providing as much information as you can.”

“Camp _____ provides an inclusive environment for our campers. We welcome campers of all abilities.”

Communicate with Parents

Ask any camp director if there are campers in each session whose parents did not identify them as having a disability and the answer would be “yes.”

Why don't parents disclose that their child has a disability or need for accommodation or support?

Parents send their children to a Jewish summer camp for a variety of reasons. Camp can expose children to different Judaic experiences and activities that they may not have at home or in Hebrew school. Camp provides opportunities to meet new friends. Camp can give campers opportunities to specialize in specific areas such as swimming, boating, music and drama. Regardless of the reason, camp is a different experience than school, and some parents may feel that their child has had enough “special” services during the year.

Some parents do not share information about their child's disability related needs because they themselves may have difficulty adapting to the diagnosis or may be uncomfortable talking about it. They may not even think that sharing information could enhance the child's camp experience.

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Parents may have experienced the impact that a disability label has on the child, sometimes resulting in stigmatization, social marginalization or exclusion. This may diminish opportunities to participate in camp and have a positive experience.

Nothing is more important to the process of inclusion than trust.

Sometimes we do not provide the opportunity for parents to share information that will help in planning and in building a collaborative relationship with them. Initial registration materials should include questions that encourage parents to provide information about their child's specific needs. When appropriate, camps should use more detailed follow-up questionnaires that ask for specific information about the child.

Who better to share information with you than the parents? Asking the right questions may help you gain insight into what the child is used to at home, and can help you prepare for supporting them at camp.

Appendix A contains a complete set of forms that you can customize to gather information from parents, campers and professionals in the child's life, provided parents have signed a release.

Build Relationships Through Collaboration

Camp administrators are experts at incorporating all of the tools to create a great camp experience. Parents are experts on their own children. Collaboration occurs when the partnership is established early on, in a balanced relationship where everyone is valued, respected and appreciated for the expertise they bring. Establishing collaboration with parents is critical to success at camp. It starts with a good intake process and conversation with parents about their child before camp starts. Some basic considerations include:

- Home routines for waking up, bedtime, brushing teeth, washing up
- What works, what doesn't work
- Preferred method of communicating and frequency: email, phone, text, daily, when concerns emerge, as needed
- Medications
- Finding out strengths
- Sensory needs (reactions to loud noises, fabrics, etc.)
- Sleeping habits
- Peer relationships

Communicate with Parents During Camp

It takes a great deal of trust and faith for parents of a child with a disability to be ready to send them to summer camp. Until now, they have seen and interacted in person with their child every day. They know his or her eating preferences and habits, as well as the child's self-care needs. Parents instantly understand what a child is feeling and understand what he or she is communicating or asking, even if the child is nonverbal. Now, perhaps for the first time other than school, which is only for a few hours per day, parents are finding themselves in a position where they must entrust their precious child to strangers—us! With this trust comes a responsibility on the part of camp to communicate with parents. How do we keep parents in the loop? How much, how often, and through what communication mechanisms do we stay in touch?

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Consider the camp experience from the parents' perspective. They dropped off their child on the first day of camp and have absolutely no way to really hear how the experience is going. Most camps do not allow phone calls. Campers must write home but what camper, typically developing or otherwise, communicates much in writing? Campers with disabilities may write a few words, which is exciting for the parents, but they can't really capture the camp experience in a handwritten letter.

So what is a parent to do? All camp parents wake up each morning and check the camp website/photo gallery for photos of their children. They scroll through often hundreds of photos until they find a photo or two of their child. And they proceed to carefully study each photo! Why does he look sad? How come no kids are near him? Doesn't he have any friends? Is that a bug bite? Is that sunburn? Where is his sunscreen?

Remember these things and you will begin on a positive note:

1. Be consistent
2. Decide who should communicate with parents
3. Share good things

How and When to Keep in Touch with Parents?

- Call or send an email to parents of all new campers by the first morning. Parents sigh a sigh of relief just knowing their child ate dinner and slept through the night! And directors, proceed to drop a note to all parents, one by one, within the first few days of camp.
- Send out a global, general weekly update to all families, including a few paragraphs about the happenings of the division and about the welfare of the entire division. A few well-chosen photographs of happy children never hurt as well!
- Start a Facebook group open only to parents of campers in the disabilities program; it is a way for parents to view photos and connect with each other as well as with the inclusion director.
- Tell parents how you prefer to be contacted and when they can realistically expect a reply. Some inclusion directors don't have an office and don't go by the main office more than once a day. A message left in the coordinators' mailbox may not get returned for a day or two, which is insufferably long for a parent. Some directors prefer a parent to take their chances and call the director's cell phone. Others prefer an email. Some actually prefer text messages. Decide on your preferred method of communication and share this with parents. And if parents do leave a message, be sure to return it promptly. There are times when it may be necessary to set limits with parents and to let them know that, if you are on the phone or online returning emails, then you are NOT with the campers and staff, which is crucial for the safe running of the program. They will appreciate the honesty and candor and in most cases will be respectful and understanding.
- Tell parents who on the team will be their "point person." It may be counterintuitive but the MORE you share with parents, the LESS they will call, write, and text to ask about their children! This is why regular updates go a long way. Once per four week session, the bunk counselors should write a camp-issued postcard to each parent. Such postcards are always upbeat and share a few details about the campers' activities. Be sure the division head or director approves the content before it is sent out.

Staff Training

When to do staff training on disability inclusion: Training Week or Training Day

Staff training on how to support campers with disabilities in an inclusive setting should be part of training week or training day. All staff should participate because, in an inclusive camp, every one will engage with campers who have disabilities.

The Camp Staff Training Guide, developed by RCII Inclusion Specialists, is available as a free download at www.rcii.org. Additionally, RCII's team of trainers can assist you in targeted training to address your most challenging concerns.

Who should participate in disability inclusion training?

Camp director, administrative team, counselors, junior counselors and counselors in training, specialists, kitchen staff, inclusion specialist or one-on-one support people, volunteers and camp maintenance staff.

Continuing training after camp begins:

There are a number of ways to provide ongoing training to support your staff and each is important in it's own right.

- Weekly staff meetings
 - Include a short training at your weekly staff meeting. Several examples of training are included in the *Camp Staff Training Guide*. You can also contact one of the RCII team to discuss training to address specific concerns at info@rcii.org.
 - Staff can share successes that they and/or her campers have had during the week. This can include challenges and how they overcame them.
- Specific or emerging needs training
 - We know that issues can crop up, and the best time to deal with them is as they happen. Often the concern is about a camper's specific behavior or pattern. Sometimes an issue is occurring in more than one bunk or more than one camper is struggling with a behavior or rules. **The RCII team is always available to discuss training solutions with you.** There may be others on the camp staff who has had similar concerns so you might find ideas there too.
- One to One Conversations
 - Sometimes finding the time to have one to one conversations may pose challenges, but the time spent can be well worth it! This helps identify the problem and talk through ways to address it. You may find that the results can be shared at staff meetings or specific trainings.
- Friends Including Friends training (Appendix C)
 - The RCII Friends Including Friends training provides each camper the opportunity to learn together about similarities and differences, helping to develop social skills and appreciation for each other, and fostering interdependence. This Friends Including Friends training takes about 45 minutes and will provide insights and information for all campers in a fun and thoughtful program.

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About Simulation Training

The Ruderman-Chabad Inclusion Initiative does not endorse simulation training. Simulations tend to exaggerate specific problems that people who live with disabilities may face and it does not teach the importance of relationships and interdependence, which are the hallmarks of inclusion. Training that focuses on a specific feature of a diagnosis tends to provide inaccurate generalizations about a group of people who happen to have the same diagnosis. Every person who lives with a disability, regardless of diagnosis, is unique.

Click here for a compelling post by Emily Ladau, a disability rights advocate on why simulation training does not help us understand anything useful about living with a disability. By putting someone in the spotlight highlighting perceived challenges and deficits does not help understand anything about that person.

http://www.huffingtonpost.com/emily-ladau/i-wont-disability-simulation_b_4936801.html

The activities provided in the ***Camp Staff Training Guide*** in the RCII Resource Hub are designed to promote interdependence and support.

Setting Up Your Bunk for Success

The environment can play a role in successful inclusion.

- Tour camp in the order the daily schedule will follow. Bring your visual schedule with you so that you can point out places to campers.
- Put a **STOP** sign at the inside door of your unit so campers will know not to run ahead or leave without getting your permission.
- Plan bed placement to provide personal space for campers who need it.

Managing Transitions and New Routines Daily Life at Camp

- Camp routines and activities may be unfamiliar to many newer campers. Returning campers can always benefit from refreshers.
- There are many ways to acclimate campers to daily life at camp. The importance and necessity of setting up structure and routines cannot be overemphasized!

Adapting Daily Routines—All in a Camp Day

Kids come to camp with established home and school routines. How do you know what those routines are? How do you help campers adapt to the camp morning routine?

Click [here](#) for a training module you can use to help your staff think about their own routines, preferences and what happens when something disrupts the routine. (Morning Routine link)

Let's go through a typical camp day with some ideas on how to adapt the activities. We encourage you to be creative, and think of ways to adapt the activities as appropriate to the needs of the campers.

Loudspeakers. Startle responses, sensory issues.

- Initiate all loudspeaker use with quiet music rather than words or loud music.

Wake Up-dressing-breakfast-toileting things-showering-bathing-etc.

- Planning the night before
 - What to wear
 - Review next days schedule-visual schedule

Dining Room Protocol/children who have difficulty with a lot of sensory stimulation. Quiet space for all campers if they choose to eat there, modify the space to include noise buffers (e.g. short walls, etc.) (self-selecting), ear buds, iPod music, ask parents how child stays calm in chaotic rooms and situations.

Davening

- *Davening* at camp/standing/not standing. Some children are not able to stand for long periods of time or at all. They need to know that it is acceptable to not stand. Provide chairs with arm rests to help kids stand up. Announce that those who can, please stand. Sitting is OK too.

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- **Materials-siddur.** Personal *t'filah*. Some children require a large print *siddur* or a picture *siddur*.
- **Davening** may be difficult for some children to sit through. A brief break or going to a quiet space to *daven* may be a good solution.
- Laminate a *siddur* and rebind.
- Put tabs in the *siddur* using Popsicle sticks or post-it tabs. Use a music stand or recipe book rest to hold the *siddur*.
- Announce the page numbers often.
- Create a visual schedule for *davening* so campers can anticipate the service order, as needed.

Bunk Clean-up. All campers can be responsible for bunk clean-up. Break down tasks into small steps. Create visual laminated cards of jobs, and have kids pick them or assign them to campers. Change it up so jobs get passed around.

Rest Hour. Reading, small group activities, listen to audio books and music using headphones. Have fidgets on hand for campers who need to be in constant motion.

Canteen. Consider medication contraindications, food allergies, and watch for peer pressure for kids who are on limited diets. Work with campers on how to manage their canteen account and budgeting. This can be a teaching opportunity for all the campers.

Sports. Can sports be adapted? Yes! It's about participating, so please remember this when campers who may be slower at moving or figuring out the game need support! Work with campers who are not able to play a particular sport to play another role such as timekeeper. At camp, it's not about winning.

Evening Activities

- Establishing evening routines
- Review schedule for the next day
- Ask campers to share one good thing that happened today. Keep a log of campers' responses. Individual responses can be shared with the child's parents.

Behavioral support

- Have a plan in place for when a camper is showing indications that a situation may be too much. Think about what consistently is difficult for a child to manage. How can you make that experience less stressful? For example, all camp gatherings might include loud music, sitting on the floor for long periods of time, crowding, bright lights or changes in lighting, or even long periods of time between activities. A plan for campers who have difficulty in these situations might include the counselors watching for changes in mood or behavior and moving the child to a quiet space for a few minutes or even the rest of the evening.
- Use cues with campers so that they can let you know if they need a break or if something is bothering them. Establish what the cue will be with the parents so they can practice at home before camp. Then at camp, sit down with the child to reinforce the cue.
- Transitions can cause tremendous anxiety for some campers. Always use a schedule and share with the campers what they need to know that will make them comfortable. Consider showing them the activity space and where they will sit before hand.

Visual Schedules

A daily visual schedule is a critical component to a structured environment. A visual schedule will tell the campers about upcoming activities and the sequence in which they occur. A visual schedule is a practical tool to communicate the daily activities for *all* campers.

Visual schedules are important for children with disabilities because they:

- Help address difficulty the child might have with sequential memory and organization of time.
- Assist children with comprehension problems to understand what is expected of them.
- Lessen the anxiety level, and reducing the potential for challenging behavior by providing structure for the camper to organize and predict daily and weekly events. Schedules clarify that activities happen within a specific time period and that “break time” is coming, but after activity time. This also will alert the camper to any changes of schedule that might occur.
- Assist the camper in transitioning independently between activities and environments by showing them where they go next.
- Based on a “first-then” strategy; first you do____, then you do____, rather than an “if-then” approach. This first-then strategy allows the first expectation to be modified as needed. Example: A camper is having particular difficulty with participation in learning to float on his back due to anxiety, or change of instructors. The task can be modified so that the child has to attempt the skill for 3 minutes first and then he/she has a break as indicated on the visual schedule.
- Can incorporate various social interactions into the camper’s daily schedule (e.g. requiring appropriate social greetings, initiating a conversation at lunch, showing a completed project to a friend or counselor, etc.)

How do I Make a Visual Schedule?

Use your computer and search for images on your browser. Or, the campers can help by cutting photographs out of magazines that represent different activities during the day.

You can print from your computer, or you can use paper to write the name of the activity and the time, and then paste your magazine photos. It’s always a good idea to review the next day before bedtime or in the morning after waking up!

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Schedules and Planning Transitions

Vertical schedule

8:00 Wake Up
8:30 Line Up – Flagpole
8:40 Breakfast
9:20 Learning Groups
10:15 Cabin Clean Up
10:45 1st Morning Activity
11:35 Snacks
11:50 2nd Morning Activity
12:50 Wash Up
1:00 Lunch
1:45 Rest & Relaxation Time
2:30 1st Afternoon Activity (Electives)
3:30 2nd Afternoon Activity
4:20 Snacks
4:30 3rd Afternoon Activity
5:30 Shower Hour
6:30 Line up – Flagpole
7:00 Dinner
7:45 Rest & Relaxation Time
8:15 Night Activity
9:15 Cabin Time
9:45 Lights Out

Visual Schedule

7:15-7:45	Wake Up 
7:45-8:30	Morning Prayers 
8:30-9:15	Breakfast 
9:15-10:00	Clean the Bunk 
10:00-11:00	Swim 
11:00-12:00	Drama 
12:00-1:00	Sports 
1:00-1:45	Lunch 

1:45-2:30	Rest 
2:30-3:30	Music 
3:30-4:30	Tennis 
4:30-5:30	Nature 
5:30-6:30	Shower 
6:30-7:15	Dinner 
7:15-8:30	Evening 
8:30	Bedtime 

Homesick Campers

One situation you are likely to encounter in any bunk is that of a camper who is homesick. What would you do? Would you talk to that camper and provide support to him so that she can worry less, work with him to adapt to camp life, address what she needs in order to make her camp experience more successful? You would find out what they need and support them.

When campers who have disabilities bunk and participate in an inclusive camp, the philosophy is the same as when we support a camper who is homesick or needs help adapting to camp life. It is just what we do. Camp staff works together as a team with parents, bunkmates and the camper to support the child in the camp environment.

Communicating About Campers Within Camp: Some “Who’s” and “How’s” and Maintaining Confidentiality

For a parent, the only thing worse than having a child sent home is learning that the child is having difficulties only when the fateful call comes. It is extremely important for camps to devise and utilize systems for keeping timely track of camper issues and then communicating them to parents.

Some camps utilize some version of weekly camper care meetings. The camp director, the director of camper care or inclusion director, and other support personnel participate in one staff meeting per week where each camper is briefly reviewed. In some camps, they are assigned a color: green (all is well), yellow (minor concerns) or red (major concerns). All yellows and reds are discussed at length. Perspectives of bunk counselors, specialists, etc. are shared and this information is documented. In some cases, notes are written in the camper file (Camp Minder, etc.) and the designated staff member may call the parent. It is always useful to have a written record about each camper. While certain events and interactions may be fresh in one’s mind during the summer, it will be a distant, unclear memory when discussing this camper or event in the fall or winter. It will also provide a useful script for conversations in the off-season with parents.

Calls home do not always mean the camper is going to be sent home. They are opportunities to share information, invite parental input, and elicit information about similar behaviors in the past. In some cases, the call is the continuation of an already collaborative relationship. Camp staff may be put in contact with the child’s therapist for additional problem solving and consultation. It is crucial that inclusion directors proactively contact parents rather than waiting until a problem is beyond repair and the child is being sent home. It is also advisable for each camp to have a clear policy of behavior that will not be tolerated at camp and under what circumstances a camper might be sent home. This policy should be shared with all parents prior to the start of camp.

Confidentiality within camp is critical. Be very mindful of when and where you discuss individual campers. Make certain that these are private conversations not overheard by any of the campers or staff not involved with the camper.

Building Relationships Between Campers

Friends Including Friends

Friends Including Friends Training Module is in Appendix C

Friends Including Friends is a new initiative for campers who are participating in an inclusive environment to teach them the importance of accepting differences and recognizing each person's individual strengths in a group. For inclusion to be successful, we first must 'level the playing field' for all campers to begin with a great start.

Friends Including Friends is about peer-to-peer connections and looking for opportunities to build relationships between campers. This can be based on common interests, favorite camp activities, or planning something special for Shabbat, a talent show or a program.

We know that most pre-teen kids are experiencing some peer pressure and judgment—they need a place to talk about it.. Friends Including Friends is not about campers without disabilities helping or doing something for campers with disabilities. In fact, disability isn't even a factor when kids are connecting on interests, activities and building relationships. In Friends Including Friends it doesn't matter who is the friend with a disability—and who doesn't have one. Everyone gains.

The training module for Friends Including Friends was developed by the RCII team for Camp Emunah and was facilitated by team member Chaya Perman. Chaya's comments and the detailed instructions will help you facilitate this important new training.

More Alike than Different: To learn more about building relationships and friendships in camp, go to CHAPTER 11: Speaking to the Bunk about Inclusion and Disabilities at the Jewish Foundation for Camps /Camp Ramah Inclusion Guide. <http://www.jewishcamp.org/sites/default/files/u12/Disabilities Resource Guide FINAL CH11 0.pdf>

Camper Bunk Meetings and Camper Care Meetings

Camper Bunk Meetings

Materials in this section were provided by Howard Blas, Director, Tikvah Program, Camp Ramah

Weekly camper bunk meetings are a necessity. Counselors should schedule these on a consistent day of the week and time.

Camper bunk meetings serve several purposes and functions.

- They are wonderful bonding opportunities, which allow the bunk members to get close to each other and to their counselors.
- They provide opportunities to share feelings and concerns.
- Bunk meetings are particularly effective in dealing with feelings about a certain camper behavior. It is important to not place blame, but rather to share openly and seek solutions.

What does a Camper Bunk Meeting Look Like?

- They should ideally take place with each camper and staff member sitting in a circle, on the floor of the bunk.
- Counselors might introduce a fun activity (making friendship bracelets) or an ice breaker (two truths and a lie).
- The meetings may be used for sharing on a given topic (a camp wide issue, a world affairs issue, etc.), or it may be used for problem solving and processing.
- It is sometimes useful to invite a more experienced senior staff member to lead or co-facilitate the meeting, particularly if feelings about certain camper behavior will be discussed.

Camper Care Meetings

Who Attends: Entire Divisional Staff

How Often: Once a week

Purpose: Check in about **each** camper

Process: The division head first reads the name of **each** girl and the staff must come to a consensus as to her “color” of the week:

- ☐ **green** means “all is good;”
- ☐ **yellow** means “a few difficulties; some concerns;”
- ☐ **red** means “this is serious!”

On this first time through the list, there is no discussion or commentary.

On the second time through the list, all yellows and reds are discussed. Since each staff member will have experience with the camper in a different setting—from the bunk, to swimming, to dance and Jewish learning, it is useful to get multiple perspectives. The team should discuss *why* they think this camper is yellow and what the action plan will be. All reds should be discussed up the chain of command. The director may call the family to share observations and problem solve solutions.

Bunk Counselors

Roles, Responsibilities and Chain of Command

Each person in camp has an important job and role to play in the lives of our campers. It is important to know what is in each person's job description and who to go to for help. One great thing about camp is that we never have to feel alone and unsupported. There is always somebody a little more senior, experienced and with expertise who can help us. If we all complete our jobs to the best of our abilities, and follow the chain of command, everyone will have a safe, positive camp experience.

Roles

- Works with co-counselors as part of camper care team
- Supervision and management of all aspects of bunk life
 - Safety
 - Hygiene
 - Health and wellness
 - Tiredness
 - Cleanliness
 - Bunk activities
- Monitor campers for signs of homesickness
- Assist campers to resolve conflicts with peers in the bunk/division
- Participate in weekly camper care meetings
- Plan divisional activities and participate in committees as assigned by division head
- Serve as a *dugma* (example of a positive role model) for your campers
- Help campers adjust to life at camp
- Enforce camp rules and policies (i.e. use of phones and tablets)
- Plan weekly bunk (bonding) activities and run weekly check in meetings
- Make sure to spend at least a few minutes 1 on 1 with each camper each day (follow the "rule of 3"-- never be alone with 1 camper)

When to "report up"

- Questions or concerns about something at camp
- "Gut feeling" something isn't right or going well for your campers
- Unsure of how to manage a bunk situation
- Feeling "stuck" or unsure of how to resolve an issue with your co-counselor(s)
- Witness or suspect bullying (verbal or physical)
- Camper talks of hurting herself (or has thoughts, or a plan, or has taken action i.e. cutting)
- Camper asks you to "keep a secret" (and it is more "serious" than a crush on a boy!)
- Camper talks of abuse (at camp or at home)

Chains of Command

For Administrative Issues (questions about camp policy and procedures)/Camper Behavioral Issues and Mental Health Concerns:

Counselor

Co-Counselors

Division Head

Assistant Director

Director

For Health and Medical Issues:

If non emergency: Division Head

If emergency (including but not limited to): seizure, excessive bleeding: emergency

If extreme emergency: call 911

Preventing Sexual Abuse

Training Module in Appendix B: Should be reviewed by all staff and discussed.

There is a ZERO TOLERANCE policy for sexual abuse.

Camp must be a safe environment for children, staff and volunteers. This means that children are not harmed in any way while at camp. One of the risks in any organization working with children and teens is sexual abuse. Our culture is one where sexual abuse is discussed, addressed and prevented.

As you review the information, you will learn that the strategies outlined here are appropriate in many different areas of camp life to assure the safety of all campers. We focus on child sexual abuse here because, although it is an uncomfortable subject, it must be addressed as a safety concern.

Addressing Bullying Behavior

Training module in Appendix D: Materials from eyesonbullying.com toolkit

Bullying is a critical concern for camp staff, parents and campers. The Staff Training Manual has a complete training on how counselors can deal with bullying. This should be incorporated into all camp training, and can be an ongoing training issue throughout the summer. Not only should camp staff and counselors know how to address bullying as it occurs, but campers should be involved in bunk meetings about bullying.

Appendix A

Camp Forms

Some parents do not share information about their child's disability related needs because they themselves may have difficulty adapting to the diagnosis, are uncomfortable talking about it or believe that sharing information could somehow detract from the child's camp experience.

Parents may have experienced the impact that a disability label has on the child, sometimes resulting in stigmatization, social marginalization or exclusion. This may diminish opportunities to participate in camp and have a positive experience.

Sometimes we do not provide the opportunity for parents to share information that will help in planning and in building a collaborative relationship. Initial registration materials may not ask questions that encourage parents to provide information about their child's specific needs. Additionally, camps may not have more detailed follow up questionnaires that ask for specific information about the child.

How can we, as professionals, guide parents and help them feel comfortable sharing information that will help us deliver a positive camp experience? What can we do to build positive, trusting and lasting partnerships with parents?

We have provided several different types of information gathering forms for you. Whether you use all of them or only some, you will gain additional information that will strengthen the bonds between home and camp, ensuring a greater chance of success for the camper.

Registration, Information, Admission and Intake

Some materials are adapted from the Foundation for Jewish Camp Guide

We hope that the resources we've provided will guide you to ease parents concerns. This information will help you to plan supports for individual campers based on their needs to ensure better opportunities for a successful summer.

These forms can be used as appropriate for your organization. You may choose to use all or just those that are necessary for your own purposes:

- 1.) **Camper Application Supplement.** This form should be included as part of the application process for ALL campers. Besides providing helpful information on each camper, it also begins to establish the relationship between you and the family.
- 2.) **Information Phone Call.** The goal of the initial phone call with the family is to begin developing a relationship with them and to talk about the child's strengths, interests, and needs. After this conversation, if your camp seems like a good fit for the child, you will follow up with a request for more information if the child requires additional support at camp.
- 3.) **Camp Intake Form.** This form should be completed by the parents/guardians of the child and provides detailed information to help you plan the kinds of supports and accommodations the camper will need. Feel free to add your own questions to this form.
- 4.) **Health/ Medical History and Information.** This particular form should be completed by parents/guardians of the child. The child's physician must complete a *separate* medical form. Use the physician medical form that you have been using.
- 5.) **Parent Interview.** This form has questions that you can ask after you have reviewed the Camper Intake Form and Health/Medical History and Information provided by the parent to clarify any questions or concerns you have.
- 6.) **Camper Interview.** This form has questions you can ask the camper during an in-person visit if you follow that procedure.
- 7.) **School Staff/Therapist Information.** Use this form ONLY if you have had the parents complete the Release of Information form.
- 8.) **Release of Information.** This form should be completed and signed by the parent(s) for EACH of the providers for whom they grant permission for you to speak with. Without the signed release for each provider, you cannot talk with him or her.

Camp Administrators Inclusion Guide

Camp Gan Israel

Camper Application Supplement

Dear Parents,

In order to help Camp Gan Israel staff to provide a meaningful, nurturing, and successful camp experience for your child this summer, we would like you to take a few moments to reply to this request and respond to the 4 questions below. If you need more space, use the back of this page.

If you would like to discuss your answers in greater detail, please complete this form and return it as soon as possible. We will contact you after we receive this form.

- ☐ I would like to talk with Camp to provide more information in addition to completing this Camper Application Supplement.

Best time of day to contact you:

Day phone:

Evening phone:

1. Your child will likely have some counselors who do not yet know him or her. In 3 to 5 sentences, please describe your child to someone they have not met yet. You may want to say a few words about the family, community, areas of strength and challenges, hobbies, personality, etc.

2. What supports, systems or reminders might your child need to be most successful at camp? (examples: visual or written schedules, prompts/reminders, a “go to” person; organizational systems for belongings).

3. Are there any supports, therapies or services your child receives at school or in the community during the school year? If yes, please provide details.

4. Does your child take any medication on a regular basis? Please list the medications, times of administration, dosage and what each medication is for. Your doctor will also provide this information in the mandatory medical form.

Please return this form to: Camp Gan Israel.

Camp Administrators Inclusion Guide
Information Phone Call

A more detailed information form (in this packet following the Telephone Information Phone Call form) should be completed by the parents followed by either an in person or phone meeting arranged with the family and the camper.

Child's Name: _____

Date of Birth: _____ Age: _____

Name of School: _____ Child's Grade: _____

Returning Camper? Yes No

1) Tell me a little about your child's strengths.

2) Tell me a little about your child's interests.

3) Has your child attended any type of camp before? If yes, which camp? (Assess whether it was a specialized or typical camp, the camper to staff ratio, whether the child had any additional supports, as well as why the camp was/ was not a good fit for the child.)

4) What type of classroom setting(s) is the child currently in at school (e.g. specialized and/or typical classroom)?

5) Does your child receive any special supports or accommodations throughout the day at school? (e.g. pull-out services including resource room/learning specialist/therapies; social skills group; accommodations within the environment such as preferential seating or a behavior chart; modifications to classwork or materials such as larger print, less items, use of a computer for writing; assistance with transitions, etc.)

6.) Tell me about your child's language and communication skills. (e.g. speaks in full sentences, expresses

needs verbally, back and forth conversations, self-advocacy, shyness around speaking, etc.)

- 7.) Does your child have any history of being verbally or physically aggressive? (e.g. calling other children names, hitting, kicking, biting, throwing things, etc.)
- 8.) How much assistance/ supervision does your child require to complete daily living skills (e.g. *toileting* skills wiping self, going into restroom on own, any accidents; *dressing* – such as changing for swim; *eating* – fine motor skills like opening wrappers, feeding, using a napkin, etc.)
- 6.) If the child requires assistance, what type of help is needed? (e.g. visual or verbal reminders, physical assistance, etc.)
- 7.) Throughout the call, try to assess whether this child seems like he/ she will requires extra support at camp and what types of extra support. If it is still unclear, ask the parent:
- 8.) What type of extra support do you feel would be helpful for your son/ daughter in the camp environment?

*If the child seems like he or she could be a good fit and you decide to move forward with a meeting, encourage the parent to bring any documentation of current accommodations or supports that help the child at home and at school to the meeting (e.g. behavior management plan, 504 Plan, IEP, etc.

Camper Information Form
To be completed by parents/guardians

Before meeting with your family, we would like to have a little more information about your child to help guide our conversation. Please answer as honestly as possible, so that we can work together to provide a positive experience for your child.

Child's Name:

Date of Birth:

Grade entering in the fall:

Family Information

With whom does the camper reside?

Parent(s) Name(s)

Child's Primary Address

Phone Number(s)

Names and ages of siblings

Camp experience:

Has your child ever attended day camp?

If yes, what camp(s)?

Did your child have any special accommodations or support? Please tell us what those were.

What worked well?

What didn't work?

Has your child ever attended overnight camp?

If yes, what camp(s)?

Did your child have any special accommodations or support? Please tell us what those were.

What worked well?

What didn't work?

About Your Child

Please describe your child's strengths.

What are your child's hobbies and areas of interest?

What are your goals for your child at camp this summer?

Has your child's disability been professionally evaluated? Yes No

Please list the diagnosis (ex. Autism, ADHD, anxiety disorder, Intellectual disability, oppositional defiant disorder, cerebral palsy, traumatic brain injury, Tourette's syndrome, mood disorder, etc.). Please list all.

What school does your child attend?

What subjects does your child enjoy most at school?

Is your child unable to participate in any activity due to medical restrictions? Please explain.

Describe communication methods that your child uses (speech, written, sign language, etc.).

Describe your child's social interactions and friendships with same age peers.

What situations might cause anger or frustration for your child?

How does your child react when angry or frustrated?

Please describe the challenging behaviors which have been observed at home or at school and the strategies which have been most effective in managing them (e.g. written or picture schedules, point systems, praise, time outs, etc.):

Describe any specific behavioral plan used for your child.

Describe the best way to redirect your child or to engage him/her in an activity.

Does your child wander or run away, display aggressive behavior toward others, harm him/herself or destroy property? Please explain.

Describe the best way to introduce or explain new tasks or make transitions between activities.

Please list any phobias/fears that may cause behavioral difficulties.

Does your child require any assistance or reminders for toileting, feeding, bathing or dressing? Please describe.

What is your child's bedtime routine and wakeup pattern?

Special dietary concerns or needs.

Have there been any changes in the family or home situation over the past year?

Please share any other information and offer any suggestions that you think would help us to provide a successful summer for your child.

Additional Information

Vision:

Does your child wear glasses? How often?

Does your child wear contact lenses? How often?

Any other vision issues? If yes, please explain:

Hearing:

Does your child wear hearing aids? How often?

Does your child have cochlear implants?

Any other hearing issues? If yes, please explain:

Other Assistive Technology/Devices:

Aside from those mentioned above, does your child regularly use any assistive devices (e.g. for communication, writing, mobility, etc.)? If yes, please explain.

Sensory Sensitivities:

Does your child exhibit any sensory issues/sensitivities? Please check if appropriate.

- ☐ Bright lights
- ☐ Loud noises
- ☐ Crowds
- ☐ Smells or odors
- ☐ Pain
- ☐ Temperature hot/cold
- ☐ Food textures
- ☐ Fabric textures
- ☐ Other- Please describe:

Please explain how this might impact your child at camp:

Allergies:

Does your child have allergies? Please list:

How do you manage your child's allergies?

Does your child take medication for allergies? If yes,
please list.

What should we know about your child's reaction to exposure to allergens?

Diet:

Does your child have any dietary restrictions? If yes, please explain

Activities:

Does your child have any activity restrictions? If yes, please explain.

Personality and Social Skills Information

Please check all that apply to your child. This is a broad list of traits to help us find a starting point. Please feel free to add your own.

- ☐ Affectionate
- ☐ Passive
- ☐ Sad
- ☐ Very Active
- ☐ Self-confident
- ☐ Careless
- ☐ Nervous
- ☐ Fearful
- ☐ Even Tempered
- ☐ Aggressive
- ☐ Immature
- ☐ Talkative
- ☐ Sensitive
- ☐ Restless
- ☐ Cheerful
- ☐ Fearless
- ☐ Quiet
- ☐ Friendly
- ☐ Independent

- ☐ Dependent
- ☐ Reflective

Please list any other current health conditions that your child is experiencing but that have not been mentioned above (e.g., tics, anemia, diabetes, seizure disorder, etc.)

Medications:

Please list all medications and vitamins that your child is currently taking and the purpose of the medication/vitamin/supplement.

Social Functioning:

How does your child tend to do socially – does he/she prefer to participate and be with other children, to be more of an observer, or to engage in more solitary activities?

Does your child require encouragement and support to join in group activities? If yes, what works? What doesn't work?

Please describe your child's strengths and challenges during social interactions.

Emotional and Behavioral Information:

Does your child experience challenges with behavior or emotions?

Does your child have a mental health condition diagnosis? If yes, please explain.

What are triggers or situations that your child finds challenging?

How does your child show that he/she is feeling frustrated, upset, anxious, or overwhelmed? What are the signs or behaviors?

What has been effective to help your child manage those situations in which he/she becomes frustrated, upset, anxious, hyperactive, or overwhelmed?

What specific activities help to soothe and calm your child?

What is the best way to help your child transition from one activity to the next?

Does your child exhibit any repetitive behaviors? If yes, please indicate how the behaviors are addressed at home and school.

Does your child have a behavior management plan at home and/or at school? If yes, please indicate the behaviors that are addressed by the plan.

Does your child have any history of the behaviors listed below? If yes, please check all that apply:

- ☐ verbal aggression (e.g. name-calling, using disrespectful language towards others)
- ☐ physical aggression (e.g. hitting, biting, kicking, throwing, scratching people or things)
- ☐ Self-injurious behavior (what does your child do?)
- ☐ Wandering away from the group or activity
- ☐ Running away or bolting from another person, group or activity

Have there been any recent changes or stressors in your child's life that would be helpful for us to know about (e.g. new baby, move to new home, divorce, death, change of schools, family illness, etc.)? If yes, how has your child reacted to those changes?

Daily Life Skills:

Does your child have difficulty and require support with any of the activities below? If yes, please check all that apply and explain.

- ☐ Eating
- ☐ Dressing
- ☐ Changing for swimming
- ☐ Toileting
- ☐ Riding in a vehicle
- ☐ Reading
- ☐ Writing
- ☐ Showering
- ☐ Waking up
- ☐ Going to bed
- ☐ Anticipating and preparing for next activity
- ☐ Time management
- ☐ Cleaning up after self
- ☐ Other, please explain

Additional Information:

Is there anything that we have not yet covered that you think would be important for us to know?

Parent/Guardian Name/ Signature

Date

Parent Interview

Where possible we encourage you to visit the family and child in their home environment.

Explain that the purpose of the interview is to be as prepared as possible for each camper. Any information the parents give us will be helpful in creating a fun, safe, and successful camp experience for their child. Most questions should lead to a conversation about the topic as related content, rather than just a specific answer to the question. The goal is to have the parent(s) provide good insights on creating supports and accommodations for their child as a camper. This interview is conducted *after* parents have returned the Camper Information Forms so that if you have any questions or need clarification that can happen in the Parent Interview. Use the questions on this form as appropriate for the child.

General Interests

What are your child's interests/hobbies?

What motivates your child?

What camp activities do you think your child will enjoy?

What will he/she not enjoy?

Are there any specific things/situations of which your child is frightened?

What are your child's favorite foods? Least favorite foods?

Communication Skills

How does your child communicate? (2-3 word sentences, conversational level, does not use spoken language, adaptive communication device, etc.)

How does your child communicate basic needs? (E.g. bathroom, hungry, tired, etc.)

If your child uses a communication device, will it be sent to camp?

Social Skills

How well does your child relate with peers?

What is difficult for your child in social interactions?

Does your child have opportunities outside of school to socialize or spend time with peers?

What is the best way for your child to communicate with friends post-camp? (E.g. email, Facebook, letters, etc.)

Behavior

How does your child communicate when frustrated? Happy? Scared? Sad?

Does your child have any significant behavioral challenges (i.e. Aggression, self-injurious, shutting down, tantrums)? If so, describe in detail.

What are common triggers and when do these behavioral challenges typically occur?

What do you do to intervene?

What helps your child relax?

Does your child have trouble transitioning from activity to activity? What strategies are helpful?

Does your child exhibit any self-stimulating behaviors, repetitive behaviors or speech patterns, or other behavioral quirks?

Self-Help

How independent is your child in self-care/daily living skills (i.e. dressing, eating, toileting, and showering)?

What supports are used to help your child with self-care? (e.g. assistance with self-care, prompting, etc.)

Are there any special concerns/suggestions for supporting your child with self-care or hygiene?

For females: Does your daughter get her period? If so, does she need any assistance with feminine hygiene?

Medical Needs

What medications does your child take?

Are there any medical conditions we should be aware of?

Are there any psychological conditions we should be aware of?

Does your child have any history of seizures? If so, how do seizures present? What are specific triggers? What is the current action/treatment plan in the event that your child has a seizure?

Does your child have any allergies? Does he/she carry an Epi Pen?

Sleeping Habits

What time does your child usually go to bed?

Wake up in the morning?

Does your child have any special bedtime rituals?

Does your child have any sleep disturbances? (E.g. Trouble sleeping through the night, sleepwalking, nightmares, bedwetting)

Do you have any suggestions for making bedtime go smoothly?

Camp Related Activities

Can your child swim? How well?

Has your child had swimming lessons?

Do you have any concerns about your child in the water or lessons?

Does your child have fear of the water?

Does your child have any fine or gross motor difficulties, or physical restrictions? How will they affect his/her participation in camp activities?

Are there any physical accommodations that your child will need or would find helpful in navigating the physical space at camp?

Are there any safety concerns that we should be aware of? What are they?

Does your child attend services? Does your child know any of the prayers?

What expectations do you have for your child's camp experience?

Is there anything else we need to know to make sure your child has a successful, fun, camp experience?

Sensitive Topics to Address with Parents/Guardians

The following topics and questions may be helpful to address directly since they represent information that families may be hesitant to write on a form or bring up in conversation. Families' responses to these topics can provide us with information that can help us to better assess the supports that the child will need in a summer camp program. It will be up to those meeting with the parents to determine whether to address most of these questions on a routine basis and explain to parents that it is the policy, or to address only those questions that seem like they may be relevant on a case-by-case basis. For many of the questions, examples of behaviors are provided, which may be used to make it easier for the parents to understand the questions if necessary. In most cases, these questions are best addressed without the child present; however, depending upon the parents' responses, some follow-up with the child may be necessary.

**In addition to these topics, remember to follow-up on any red flags or information that you would like to hear more about, from the parents' responses to the Camper Information Form.*

Family

If the child's parents are divorced, who has legal custody of the child and who is able to make decisions about the child's care and services?

Do the parents have joint custody (even if the child lives most of the time with one parent) or is it sole custody?

Who has permission to pick the child up from camp?

This information is important with regard to who can sign the child up for camp, who can make medical decisions, who can sign releases for staff to speak with the school, a therapist, etc.

Emotional/ Behavioral Concerns

Does the child have any history of being bullied and/or bullying others? What happened? How was it resolved? Does the child still have sensitivities/ triggers related to the incident(s) that may make them act in certain ways (e.g. feel like others are laughing at/ looking at/ talking about them, sensitivity to certain words or comments, etc.)?

Does the child have any specific fears/ phobias?

Has the child ever talked about hearing or seeing things that are not real or that other people do not see or hear?

(Assess any history of psychotic thinking/ episodes.)

Has the child ever tried to hurt him/herself, threatened to hurt him/herself, spoken about wanting to hurt him/herself or take their own life?

Does the child have any history of psychiatric hospitalization(s)? If yes, how many times? When? What statements, behaviors, or emotions led to the hospitalization(s)? For how long was the child hospitalized (in each incident)?

Camper Intake (Questions to ask the child at a home visit)

How are you feeling about coming to camp?

What should I know about you?

What are some of the things you like to do at home or at school?

Is there anything you really want to do while you're at camp?

What are some of the things you don't like to do?

Is it easy for you to make new friends? How can we help you do that?

Is there anything about camp that you're worried about?

Do you have any questions for me about camp?

Explain that they can be in touch at any time with questions or things they would like me to know.

School Staff or Therapist Information

To be used if you need further clarification of the child's needs from a professional perspective.
All questions should be answered specific to the school/community environment only.

What is your position?

How long have you known the student?

How often and what type of contact do you have with the student?

Explain the school program in which the student is enrolled (i.e., self-contained, inclusive, etc.)

If the child is in a self-contained classroom, how much time does the student spend daily with his or her grade level peers?

Does the student have a paraprofessional at any time during the day? If so, what does the paraprofessional help the student with?

Describe the student's communication skills (receptive, expressive). What have you noticed is difficult for the student with regards to communication?

How does the student communicate when frustrated? Happy? Scared? Sad?

How does the student communicate basic needs? (E.g. bathroom, hungry, tired, etc.)

Are there any strategies that are helpful in supporting the student with effective communication and self-expression?

How often does the student spend time with peers? In what activities/classes?

How does the student interact with peers?

What is difficult for the student with regard to social interactions?

What supports/strategies are used to assist the student with social interactions?

Does the student have any significant behavioral challenges? (E.g. Aggression, self-injurious, shutting down, tantrums)

If so, describe in detail.

When and how often do these behavioral challenges typically occur?

Does the student have any difficulty with self-regulation or emotional regulation?

What strategies are successful in helping the student to relax?

Does the student have any difficulty transitioning from activity to activity? What strategies are helpful?

Are there any safety concerns at school? Has the student ever engaged in unsafe behaviors (E.g., running away, wandering, climbing, etc.)

What motivates the student?

What activities does the student typically enjoy the most at school?

Are there any things that the student really does not like or is scared of?

What supports should be put in place for the student to succeed in an overnight camp environment?

Camp Administrators Inclusion Guide
Information Release Form

Dear Parent/Guardian,

In order to get to know your child better and to assess how we can best support your child at camp, we will need to access confidential information from your child's physician, social worker, caseworker, therapist, teacher or other service provider.

Below you will find a statement of consent. Please sign it, and include it in the completed application packet you send back to us.

Thanks again for applying to Camp XXXX. If you have any questions, please do not hesitate to call me at _____.

Sincerely,

Director of Camp

I, _____ (Name of parent/guardian), give permission for

_____ (Name of Service Provider), _____ (Title), to provide

information about my Child, _____.

Parent/Guardian Signature: _____

Date:

City:

Appendix B

Sexual Violence and Abuse

Camp must be a safe environment for children, staff and volunteers. This means that children are not harmed in any way while at camp. One of the risks in any organization working with children and teens is sexual abuse. Our culture is one where sexual abuse is discussed, addressed and prevented. There is a zero tolerance policy.

As you review the information, you will learn that the strategies outlined here are appropriate in many different areas of camp life to assure the safety of all campers. We focus on child sexual abuse here because it is an uncomfortable subject and it must be addressed not only for safety but for the legal issues that arise when a young person is subjected.

This document provides information and strategies that should be adopted to prevent sexual abuse.

What is Child Sexual Abuse?

“Child sexual abuse involves any sexual activity with a child where consent is not or cannot be given. This includes sexual contact that is accomplished by force or threat of force, regardless of the age of the participants, and all sexual contact between an adult and a child, regardless of whether there is deception or the child understands the sexual nature of the activity. Sexual contact between an older and a younger child also can be abusive if there is a significant disparity in age, development, or size, rendering the younger child incapable of giving informed consent. The sexually abusive acts may include sexual penetration, sexual touching, or non-contact sexual acts such as exposure or voyeurism.”¹

The terms “children” and “youth” are used interchangeably and refer to anyone between the ages of zero and 17 years.

Why Do We Need Preventing Sexual Abuse Information and Strategies?

Any organization serving children and youth is responsible for the well-being and safety of the participants and staff. For example, though all youth-serving organizations are interested in helping youth develop into healthy adults, the mission of mentoring or religious organizations is often focused on fostering nurturing relationships between individual adults and youth. Because this mission results in more one-on-one activities between employees/volunteers and youth, these organizations need to adopt child sexual abuse prevention strategies that protect youth in one-on-one situations with adults.

Balancing Caution and Caring

The same dynamics that create a nurturing environment, and may ultimately protect against child sexual abuse, can also open the doors to sexually abusive behaviors. Research has shown that youth who are emotionally insecure, needy, and unsupported may be more vulnerable to the attentions of offenders.¹ By promoting close and caring relationships between youth and adults, organizations can help youth feel supported and loved and thus reduce their risk of child

sexual abuse. But that same closeness between a youth and an adult can also provide the opportunity for abuse to occur. When developing policies for child sexual abuse prevention, organizations must balance the need to keep youth safe with the need to nurture and care for them.

Guidelines on Interactions Between Individuals

Goal

To ensure the safety of youth in their interactions with employees/volunteers and with each other.

General Principles

Guidelines on interactions between individuals should be determined by an organization's mission and activities. For example, organizations that promote one-on-one activities between adults and youth may need different interaction guidelines than programs built around group activities. *Organizations should develop interaction policies before situations arise.* The strategies listed below should be tailored to the developmental age and maturity of the youth and employees/volunteers. Strategies should also match the cultural context of the population served by the organization. In this section, "adult" refers to any individual in a supervisory position, including youth.

Balancing positive and negative

- Find a balance between encouraging positive and appropriate interactions and discouraging inappropriate and harmful interactions.
- Adopt strategies with this balance in mind to ensure that youth benefit from your program without risk of sexual abuse or harm.

Critical Strategies for Guidelines on Interactions Between Individuals

Appropriate/inappropriate/harmful behaviors. Organizations should identify behaviors that fall into the categories of appropriate, inappropriate, and harmful. These categorizations can be spelled out in your code of conduct or ethics. Carefully balance the benefits of appropriate interactions with the risks associated with inappropriate interactions.

Ratios of employees/volunteers to youth. The goal of setting ratios for the numbers of employees/volunteers to youth is to ensure the safety of the youth. There is no standard ratio for all situations. When making decisions about ratios, consider contextual variables such as:

- Age and developmental level of youth and employees/volunteers. If youth or employees/volunteers are young, you may need a lower ratio, that is, fewer youth per adult.
- Risk of the activity. Does it involve a great deal of isolation from others?
- Location of the activity. Is it in a classroom that is easy to monitor or at a park, where it is

easier to lose track of individuals? Encourage employees/volunteers to actively interact with the youth to maintain adequate supervision and monitoring. *Even with a satisfactory ratio of employees/volunteers to youth, the youth are not being monitored if all of the employees/volunteers are immersed in their own conversations in a corner of the room.*

One-on-one interactions. Some organizations have a policy to limit one-on-one interactions between youth and adults (i.e., having at least two adults present at all times with youth). The goal of such a policy is to prevent the isolation of one adult and one youth, a situation that elevates the risk for child sexual abuse.

Limit one-on-one interactions whenever possible by having at least two adults present at all times with youth. Make this a mandatory policy at all times. Maintain other safeguards such as extra supervision or contact with youth and employees/volunteers and more stringent screening if the mission of your organization requires one-on-one time between employees/volunteers and youth.

Risk of interactions between youth. Your organization needs to address interactions among youth in addition to monitoring interactions between employees/volunteers and youth. Many strategies that focus on the interactions between employees/volunteers and youth can be tailored to address interactions among youth.

- Address all situations where unsupervised youth can sexually or physically abuse other youth. For example, if your organization has a policy that prevents adults from being present in locker rooms because of the risk of child sexual abuse, this may result in a situation where unsupervised youth can sexually or physically abuse other youth. A potential solution is adopting a policy that requires more than one adult to be present at all times.
- Develop policies to deal with bullying and sexual abuse so that positive interactions can be promoted while acknowledging that some interactions are inappropriate or harmful.

Prohibitions and restrictions on certain activities. Some activities, such as hazing and secret ceremonies, overnight trips, bathing, changing, bath- room interactions, and nighttime activities, pose greater risks for child sexual abuse. Prohibiting or restricting such activities will depend largely on the context of your organization. For example, a sleep-away camp would not be able to prohibit overnight trips or bathing.

Monitoring Behavior

Goal

To prevent, recognize, and respond to inappropriate and harmful behaviors and to reinforce appropriate behaviors.

General Principles

Monitoring involves observing interactions and reacting appropriately. This includes both employee/volunteer–youth and youth–youth interactions. Youth leaders often require more

supervision and monitoring because they are young, may lack judgment, and are harder to screen. Define areas for monitoring based on the organization's mission and activities.

Monitor inappropriate or harmful behaviors. Refer to your organization's interaction policies and what has been defined as inappropriate or harmful behavior. Understand the boundaries that your organization has established and identify when someone has crossed the line. Potential inappropriate behaviors include employees/volunteers showing favoritism, giving gifts, and looking for time alone with youth.

Monitor potential risk situations. Acknowledge that some situations pose more risk for inappropriate or harmful behavior than others. For example, interactions during an overnight trip are harder to monitor than interactions in a classroom.

Monitor appropriate behaviors. Acknowledge, praise, and encourage appropriate behaviors. Reward and reinforce positive interactions between employees/volunteers and youth.

Responding to what is observed. You must be prepared to respond to interactions among youth and between employees/volunteers and youth.

- Develop a monitoring protocol so that employees/volunteers are clear about their roles and responsibilities. Employees/volunteers should be prepared to respond immediately to inappropriate or harmful behavior, potential risk situations, and potential boundary violations.
- Enforce the protocol so that appropriate actions follow. Supervisors need to redirect inappropriate behaviors to promote positive behaviors, confront inappropriate or harmful behaviors, and report these behaviors if necessary.

Roles and responsibilities. All employees/volunteers should be responsible for monitoring behavior and interactions within your organization. Everyone needs to know how and what to monitor. Define roles and responsibilities by including monitoring within a job description, specifying what employees/volunteers need to do from the very beginning, and *providing training*.

Clear reporting structure within organization. Your organization should have a well-defined reporting structure so people know who to contact if they observe potentially inappropriate or harmful behavior.

- Require employees/volunteers to report any behaviors and practices that may be harmful.
- Establish direct-line and back-up reporting systems within your organization. The back-up option should be used if the incident involves the direct-line authority.
- Create a climate that encourages people to question confusing or uncertain behaviors and practices.

Observation and contact with employees/volunteers

Your organization should use multiple monitoring methods to get a clear picture of how individuals are interacting.

- Use formal supervision, including regular evaluations.
- Use informal supervision, including regular and random observation (e.g., roving and checking interactions throughout an activity period), and maintain frequent contact with employees/volunteers and youth who interact off-site.

Documentation that monitoring has occurred. Although it may be clear when other child sexual abuse prevention strategies, such as screening or environmental policies, have been implemented in your organization, it is harder to be sure that adequate monitoring is occurring. Documenting that monitoring has occurred emphasizes to employees/volunteers that it is an essential, nonnegotiable part of your organization's child sexual abuse prevention efforts.

- Use written records.
- Provide positive reinforcement when good supervision occurs.

Ensuring Safe Environments

Goal

To keep youth from situations in which they are at increased risk for sexual abuse.

Critical Strategies for Ensuring Safe Environments

Visibility. Building or choosing spaces that are open and visible to multiple people can create an environment where individuals at risk for sexually abusive behaviors do not feel comfortable abusing.

Use the following methods to increase visibility:

- Landscape to ensure open visible spaces with no possible concealment.
- Have clear lines of sight throughout the building or outside areas.
- Secure areas not used for program purposes to prevent youth from being isolated (e.g., lock closets and storerooms).
- Install windows in doors.
- Institute a "no closed door" policy.
- Install bright lighting in all areas.

Privacy when toileting, showering, changing clothes. Your organization should develop policies and procedures for reducing risk during activities such as toileting, showering, and changing clothes that consider not just the risk of employee/volunteer sexual abuse, but also the risk of inappropriate or harmful contact among youth.

Access control. Your organization should monitor who is present at all times.

- Develop policies and procedures for admitting and releasing youth so their whereabouts are always known.
- Have policies and procedures for monitoring which people outside of your organization are allowed in and under what circumstances.

Off-site activity guidelines. Your organization should define and communicate its on-site and off-site physical boundaries.

- Decide and communicate when and where your organization is responsible for the youth it serves. This is particularly important on field trips.
- Develop environmental policies for field trips, such as how to handle off-site bathroom

breaks and use of public transportation.

Transportation policies. Your organization should define who is responsible for transporting youth to and from regular activities and special events (e.g., field trips, overnight trips). Decide how to answer the following questions: • When is your organization responsible for transportation? • When are caregivers responsible? • Can a youth ride in a car with an employee/volunteer? If yes, under what circumstances? For example, can a youth be alone with an employee/volunteer in a car? • What are pick-up procedures at the end of the day or the event?

Additional Strategies to Consider

Responding to Inappropriate Behavior, Breaches in Policy, and Allegations and Suspicions of Child Sexual Abuse

Goal

To respond quickly and appropriately to (1) inappropriate or harmful behavior, (2) infractions of child sexual abuse prevention policies, and (3) evidence or allegations of child sexual abuse.

General Principles

The ultimate aim of child sexual abuse prevention efforts within youth-serving organizations is to prevent child sexual abuse from ever occurring; however, an organization needs to have communicated clearly what it and its employees/volunteers should do if policies are violated or if child sexual abuse occurs.

Define inappropriate and appropriate strategies.

- Clarify that it is *not* the role of an employee/ volunteer or your organization to evaluate or investigate an allegation or suspicion.
- Let child protective services, law enforcement, and child advocacy centers investigate allegations or suspicions.
- Know that an organization's investigation can harm the youth or the legal investigative process.

Partnering with others.

- Work with a lawyer to develop a reporting policy to ensure that it is appropriate and legal.
- Partner with child protective services, law enforcement, and child advocacy centers (www.nca-online.org) before any allegations arise to form relationships and ensure that policies are in line with the law.

¹ Preventing Child Sexual Abuse Within Youth-serving Organizations: Getting Started on Policies and Procedures. **U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES** Centers for Disease Control and Prevention National Center for Injury Prevention and Control Division of Violence Prevention Atlanta, Georgia.

Warning Signs of Possible Sexual Abuse In A Child's Behaviors

Stop It Now has created a list of possible signs of sexual abuse in children and teens.

<http://www.stopitnow.org/ohc-content/tip-sheet-7>

Any one sign doesn't mean that a child was sexually abused, but the presence of several suggests that you begin asking questions and consider seeking help. Keep in mind that some of these signs can emerge at other times of stress such as:

- During a divorce
- Death of a family member or pet
- Problems at school or with friends
- Other anxiety-inducing or traumatic events

Behavior you may see in a child or adolescent

- Has nightmares or other sleep problems without an explanation.
- Seems distracted or distant at odd times.
- Has a sudden change in eating habits. Refuses to eat. Loses or drastically increases appetite.
Has trouble swallowing.
- Sudden mood swings: rage, fear, insecurity or withdrawal.
- Leaves "clues" that seem likely to provoke a discussion about sexual issues.
- Writes, draws, plays or dreams of sexual or frightening images.
- Develops new or unusual fear of certain people or places.
- Refuses to talk about a secret shared with an adult or older child.
- Talks about a new older friend.
- Suddenly has money, toys or other gifts without reason.
- Thinks of self or body as repulsive, dirty or bad.
- Exhibits adult-like sexual behaviors, language and knowledge.

Signs more typical of younger children

- An older child behaving like a younger child (such as bed-wetting or thumb sucking).
- Has new words for private body parts.
- Resists removing clothes when appropriate times (bath, bed, toileting, diapering).
- Asks other children to behave sexually or play sexual games.
- Mimics adult-like sexual behaviors with toys or stuffed animal.
- Wetting and soiling accidents unrelated to toilet training.

Signs more typical in adolescents

- Self-injury (cutting, burning)
- Inadequate personal hygiene
- Drug and alcohol abuse
- Sexual promiscuity
- Running away from home
- Depression, anxiety
- Suicide attempts
- Fear of intimacy or closeness
- Compulsive eating or dieting

Physical warning signs

Physical signs of sexual abuse are rare. If you see these signs, bring your child to a doctor. Your doctor can help you understand what may be happening and test for sexually transmitted diseases.

- Pain, discoloration, bleeding or discharges in genitals, anus or mouth

- Persistent or recurring pain during urination and bowel movements
- Wetting and soiling accidents unrelated to toilet training

12 Myths About Childhood Sexual Abuse *

*From Camp Jenny Training Manual, Counselor/Staff Training Manual

http://www.nfty.org/kd/Items/actions.cfm?action=Show&item_id=17469&destination=ShowItem

1. **Sexual abuse only happens to girls.** One out of every four little girls is sexually molested before the age of 18. But the report adds that at least one out of every 6 boys is also abused during his youth. Children are most commonly abused between the ages of 8 and 12.
2. **Incest and molestation are sexual acts.** Like rape, incest and childhood sexual abuse are not sexual crimes. Rather, they are crimes of control, often stemming from the perpetrator's feelings of helplessness or inadequacy or rage. While many people assume that incest occurs most often in homes where the parents don't share a sexual relationship, many studies note the opposite: a father who has frequent intercourse with his wife may also seek sexual gratification with his child or other children, too.
3. **Victims are usually adolescents.** In his book, "Sexually Victimized Children," Dr. David Finkelhor notes that preadolescents are the most likely victims for a perpetrator. Current research indicates that the average little girl who is abused is eight years old at the time of her first violation.
4. **Child molesters are "dirty old men."** On the contrary, women also molest children. Studies released by the National Committee for the Prevention of Child Abuse indicate that the average age of an offender is 32. And according to the study, "Sexual Abuse of Children—Selected Reading," 80% to 90% of incestuous families involve a daughter and her father or stepfather.
5. **The perpetrator is mentally ill.** Most molesters do not have prior criminal records and are even viewed by their neighbors as "good family men or women," or "pillars of the community." Studies portray the average offender as being of average intelligence and education, and a moderate drinker who is able to provide well for his family because he holds a steady job. Frequently, the incestuous family is active in religious organizations.
6. **Incest is rare and extreme.** There are approximately 60 million people now living in the United States who survived childhood sexual abuse, and more than 1 million are currently being victimized. And while the perpetrators may express a desire to stop the abuse, incestuous affairs usually last five years or more. During this time, the abuse may take many forms: fondling, intercourse, anal intercourse, masturbation, oral sex, and rape. The most common form of sexual abuse is the "velvet glove;" the child is "lovingly" seduced, often over a number of years. Despite the outward appearances, however, this type of abuse is as devastating to the child as forcible rape.
7. **The child will forget.** The child may develop amnesia or be able to block the incidents from memory for many years, but ultimately will remember the abuse. Often the memories begin to return when the surviving adult experiences life-changing trauma, such as a divorce, the death of the perpetrator, or pregnancy. The recovering child or adult needs to talk about the abuse to free herself or himself from feelings of guilt, shame, or anger. Often, the victim interprets adult silence about the on-going abuse as censure and needs to understand that she or he was not to blame.

8. **The child asked for it.** All responsibility for any child abuse lies solely with the perpetrator, no matter how old the child was at the time of the incident, how long the abuse occurred, who the perpetrator was, or how the child was dressed or behaved. The notion that a child is sexually provocative is a myth that puts the blame on the victim. A child's behavior is neither an excuse nor an explanation for the abusive actions of the adult offender.
9. **Incest is not traumatic.** Evidence clearly demonstrates that there is significant trauma to children of all ages who are sexually assaulted. The age and personality of the child, the nature of the assault, and the support available to the survivor influence the extent of the long-lasting effects of the abuse.
10. **Children make up stories.** Statistics clearly indicate that only one out of 100 children who claimed to be victims of incest were lying, and these children needed psychiatric care. Professionals who treat child victims have found that the trauma of disclosing the abuse is so devastating that lying is seldom a factor. The truth is: children don't lie about sexual abuse.
11. **Molestation is a way of showing love.** Popular beliefs that children are possessions of their parents perpetrates the myth that childhood sexual abuse is a form of "loving." A child is vulnerable, obedient, and many times totally frightened by the authority—or threats—of the parents. Sexual advances foisted on a child leave him or her with no choice but to cooperate.
12. **Victims never treat children the way they were treated.** Unfortunately, the most common characteristic of incest and sexual abuse is that the child perpetrates other children. According to the National Institute of Mental Health, at least 300,000 young people who were they themselves abused sexually abuse other children each year. One of the many side effects from childhood sexual abuse is that the child-victim continues to victimize himself or herself...as well as others...unless he or she is able to break the cycle and become a survivor.

Appendix C: Friends Including Friends

Friends Including Friends

Peer Training for Campers

Overnight camp is a unique experience for kids to live together, build friendships and learn new skills in a Jewish environment. Often many campers are challenged by new experiences as they become accustomed to camp routines, sharing bunks and transitioning to many different activities.

The goal of Friends Including Friends, developed by the Ruderman Chabad Inclusion Initiative, is to build camp communities through peer-to-peer training. The activities in Friends Including Friends training are fun and give campers the chance to learn more about each other and themselves. Expect campers to share their thoughts and ideas as they become comfortable with each other.

We purposely did not use the words “disability” or “special needs” in the training until remarks at the end. The reason is two-fold: 1.) To understand that *each* person has is a unique individual without regard to ability; and, 2.) To value our differences as well as similarities regardless of our abilities or disabilities.

Room set-up:

- Campers seated at tables, 10 campers per table
- Flipchart, easel whiteboard or poster board set in front of room

Materials needed:

- Paper, 1 piece per camper (note-campers can divide a piece of paper into halves if there is only 1 piece of paper per camper as they will need paper for the next activity, too)
- Pen, pencil or crayon 1 per camper
- 4-5 COLOR copies of the picture (at the end of Appendix C) per table for Activity One
- Flipchart, easel, whiteboard or poster board and marker

Staffing:

One counselor at each table to assist campers to stay on task and help facilitate the discussions.

Total time: 45 minutes

Number of Activities: 2

Introduction to Friends Including Friends Training

Provide your own introduction or use this introduction that Chaya Perman shared when she facilitated this training. Her comments and reflections, in italics, are very helpful to read before you begin the training.

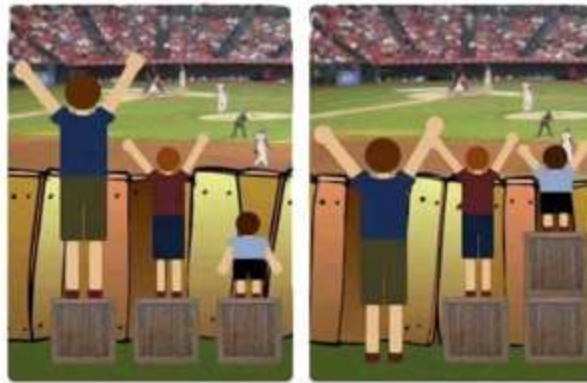
My name is...and I'm here to talk to you about friendship. At camp we have a lot of activities and things to do-and one of the most important is to make friends and treat each other with respect and caring. Today we're going to do some fun activities that will help us develop friendships between you and other campers. (Or you can improvise a short introduction).

I drove to camp from my home in Canada. I drove through large mountain forests. When I was driving at the posted speed limit and looked at the forests in the distance all the trees seemed the same, a large wall of green. Yet when I got closer and slowed down, I noticed that each and every tree was different from the next. Some were tall, some were short, some wide, some were full of leaves, others were sparse. I noticed that there were shrubs, many pines, oaks, and maple trees and so many to learn about.

Does every tree have a purpose? What are your thoughts on the need for different types of trees? *(If they don't answer right away, you might give them one or two ideas such as shade, fruits, shelter, etc).*

(Take the concept of purposes and diversity to people, how we all have certain similarities but upon a closer and more thoughtful look we are all different and unique, no two are alike. Yet everyone has a purpose, something to offer).

Activity 1: The Ballgame



Materials Needed: 4-5 COLOR copies of this picture (one for every two campers, use the larger version of this picture at the end of Appendix C), whiteboard or flip chart paper, markers.

Timing: 20 minutes: **Table discussion:** 5-8 minutes. **Large group reporting:** 1-2 minutes per table.

Leader summarize: 4 minutes

Leader:

Table discussion: Have talk through these pictures and answer these questions:

1. What is going on in the picture on the left, and the picture on the right?
2. How will you label these pictures? Why?

Be sure to include all campers at the table. Choose someone to be the table reporter who will share with the large group what words you chose and why.

Large group discussion: choose one person who will share what words they put in and why. One to two minutes per table. As they answer, write the words they've chosen on a flip chart. Don't put in categories, just list the words as they give them to you.

Leader Summary and Activity Wrap up: 4 minutes:

Everyone has different needs. In the morning, some of you need more sleep, 5 extra minutes to get out of bed. You like different foods. We don't all do the same things or like the same things, yet we often think of fairness as getting and doing the same things as everyone else. Fair isn't getting the same things as everyone else. Fair is making sure that people have what they need to be successful.

Highlight the words they've mentioned on the flip chart. Look at this list—is this about fair, or being better than someone else? Each of us has something we do better than anyone else, and there are things that we each do that someone else does better. But there are times when each of us needs something to stand on like the children in the picture so that we can all succeed when we have what we need.

(Look for the campers bringing in the concept of adapting the situation so that the small boy could see; Chaya noted that in the Friends Including Friends training she opened that up to a discussion of all types of adaptive equipment that “evens the playing field” for all).

We are partners with Hashem—Hashem didn't make us all the same. Our world is created so that every tree, every rock, and every person is unique. Hashem doesn't do things by accident. We each have something to share with those around us, something special. When we look at it this way—we recognize that we are all special and we all have something we can offer.

Activity 2: Different and Alike

Materials Needed: One pen, pencil or crayon and one piece of paper per camper

Timing: 25 minutes. **Pair Sharing:** 10 minutes. **Table Sharing:** 5 minutes.

Leader summarize and wrap up: 10 minutes

Introduction:

We all are born with different things. We get parts of us like eye color or hair color from our parents. For example, I have blue eyes that I got from my dad's side. Some of us have differences that we can see, such as wearing glasses, or having braces, or freckles. There are also differences that we have that you can't see, like special talents, things that are harder for us, things we might worry about, things we really like or really don't like.

Pair Sharing: 10 minutes:

Group the children in two rows facing each other randomly (you can assign each student to row A or row B). Have the children sit down facing each other and give each of them a paper and pencil. Each 'pair' has to write down 3 things that make them different from the person facing them, and three things that make them similar. For example—We live in different communities, one girl likes to dance, the other likes sports, one has curly hair and one has straight hair; we're both girls, we're Jewish, we're tall, we each have a sibling, we both share a room at home, we both have allergies.

Table Sharing: 5 minutes to read their answers in their table groups. Allow them to read their responses out loud.

Leader Wrap Up: 10 minutes. After the table sharing, ask one person from each table: What were you surprised to learn and hadn't thought of before? (*For example, I didn't realize that this person is so different and we could still be friends*).

Summarize for the group--Each person is different, and we still have so much in common. Every person has so much to contribute.

Ask the Group: How can you become a better friend?

Examples:

- You can be a good friend by being understanding when your friend can't do all the things you can and find a game that your friend can do.
- You can be a good friend by asking them if they need help with something.
- You can be a good friend by just hanging out with them at recess when you see they are sitting on their own.
- You can be a good friend by smiling at them or saying hello.
- There are a lot of ways you can be a good friend.

Summary ideas: Every person is different from the other and we have things that make us especially unique, such as how we look, our talents, our personalities, our strengths and our weaknesses. Having people with differences is what makes our world an interesting and colorful place to be. It gives us the opportunity to learn from each other, as well as share, teach and help one another. Imagine how boring the world would be if all the people in it were exactly the same!

I'm sure all of us have met people, including students in our class or in our school who are different than us. Sometimes the difference is something clearly we see, but sometimes it's something we don't see right away. Sometimes the difference may seem unusual or even strange to us and we may not completely understand.

Prompt discussion:

Have you ever felt left out?

How does that feel?

How would it have felt if someone invited you to play or to join them in an activity?

How can you be a better friend?

Examples for younger kids: If you see someone sitting on the side, go over to them, invite them to join you and bring them in. (*We are empowering each child with the ability to be a leader so they will become leaders in positive ways*). The important thing that you can do is to go over to them, tell them your name, ask them their name. It's OK to be nervous. The best first step is to share names, and invite them to come play with you and the others.

Examples for older kids: Ask someone who is sitting by themselves or on the sidelines "Do you want to hang out with me in our bunk? Let's have Canteen together today." If you're playing soccer, one person could be the cheerleader, or get the ball if they go out of bounds, or ask them what they want to do—then the campers don't rely on their counselors to tell them what the right thing to do.

Leader: Summary. Notice that the words “disability” or “special needs” have not been used. If we see someone with a disability, we might not walk over and welcome them or invite them to join us or even have a conversation because we don’t want to say or do the wrong thing. *(You might want to mention that there are people at camp and probably in your schools, maybe a brother or sister who has a disability).*

Imagine if we looked at everyone like we did today, what a difference it would make. Every single one of us is important and we are all different from each other in a lot of ways. Still we have so much in common.

When you meet someone with a disability, you might have to work harder, you still can find things in common, something someone has that you don’t—that’s how you become friends. You might feel nervous and that’s OK. The most important thing you can do is to be a friend and let others be your friend too.

Chaya’s observations: *A discussion was conducted about qualities and differences we don’t see. The subject of allergies came up and we discussed the need for an Epi Pen. I asked them if that was any different than a wheelchair? It was agreed that they both ‘support’ the person with a disability one invisible and one visible. One young lady said she wouldn’t run over to someone in a wheelchair so as not to make her feel “badly” about her inability to walk. We opened the discussion to analyze which was worse, not to walk over because of the difference or to leave her isolated. We returned to the original discussion of adaptive equipment and highlighted how the wheelchair doesn’t define who she is, but is rather a tool for mobility.*

For the younger campers Introduce the song ‘Who Am I’, lyrics by Abie Rotenberg (next page). Many may know it. Have a counselor lead the girls in singing of it. It will reinforce for them that there are more similarities, especially the important ones that count, than differences in each of us.

Who Am I?

Words and Music by Abie Rotenberg

I have trouble with my words, they don’t seem to come out clear
But I want you all to know me, so I’ll try
By asking one small question, it won’t take up too much time
Can you tell me, can you answer, who am I?

Oh, I know I’m very different - by the things I can not do
Why I’d find it hard to tell you my own name
So you wonder just who am I, as you try to hide your eyes
But believe me, you and I are much the same

Don’t you marvel at a sunset, as the rays shine through the clouds
And the night begins to take over the sky
Don’t you love the sound of laughter, and a lively happy tune?
Then we are not so different, you and I

And when you see a mighty eagle, as it spreads its graceful wings
Don’t you wish inside your heart that you could fly?

And when you hear a crash of thunder, don't you tremble out of fear?
Then we are not so different, you and I.

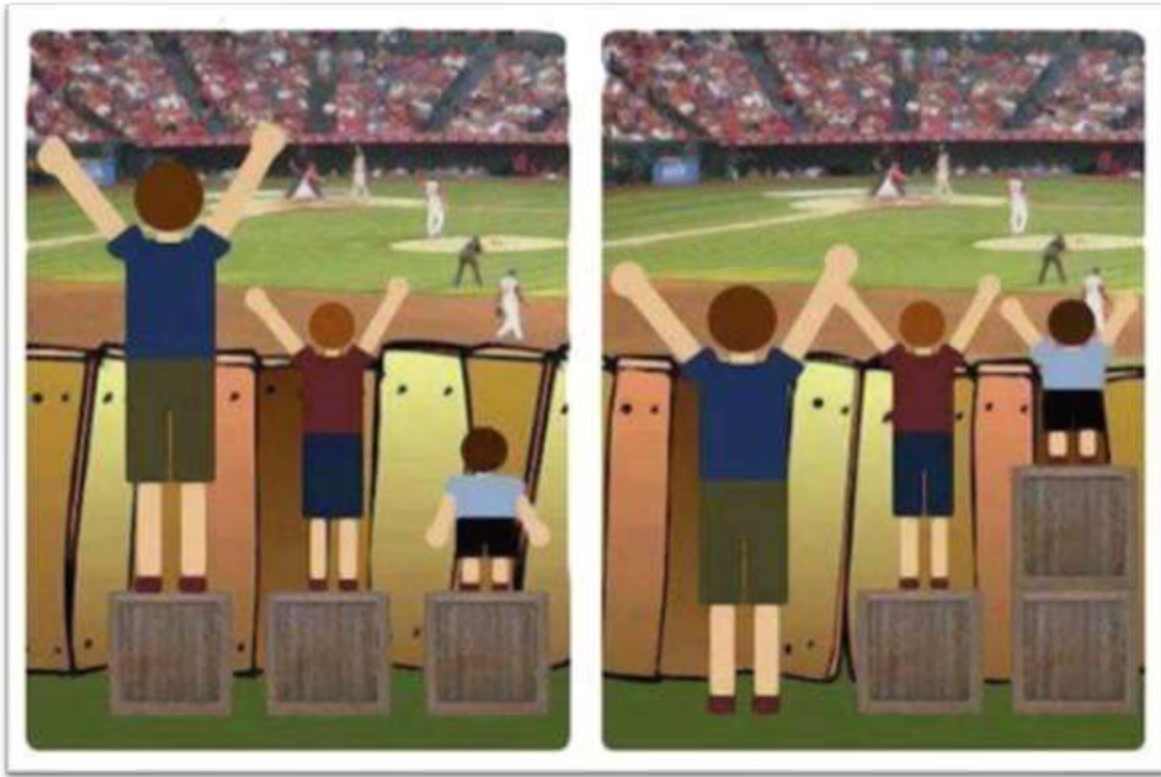
Oh, I know my legs can not hold me, and I cannot shake your hand
And that looking at me makes you feel so strange
So you wonder just who am I, as you quickly pass on by
But believe me, you and I are just the same

Have you known the pain of sadness and the feeling that it brings?
Yes I'm sure there've been some times you've had to cry.
And that loneliness is worst of all, I'm sure you will agree
For we are not so different, you and I

Do you know the joy of friendship, of caring and of love?
Somehow I get the feeling that you do.
Then we are not so different, we are very much the same...
You do know who I am...
I'm just like you

For the older campers do this tactile - visual exercise of taking a sheet of paper and crumpling it up as tight as they can. Suggest to them that as they crumple and squeeze the paper they remember hurtful things they may have said to others, heard or felt themselves. Then ask them to smooth out the sheet, to try to make it as perfect as possible. They recognize that a pattern always remains. Just as the paper can never regain its original state, our words and behavior always leaves an impact as well.

Wish them healthy and happy summer and invite them to fill out their uncrumpled sheets of paper with happy words.



Appendix D: Bullying Bullying

Materials adapted from eyesonbullying.com toolkit

This section is an overview of the session that you can offer camp staff to help them learn how to manage bullying behavior through activities. We suggest that you visit the eyesonbullying.com website for more detailed training and handouts.

Counselors will see bullying occur and this section is an important part of the training. It's important to underscore that bullying will not be tolerated.

Review these materials, which can be found in the *Camp Counselor Training Manual*.

Materials Needed: One copy of the Camp Counselor Training Manual per counselor.

Prevent Bullying

We believe that to prevent bullying in children's lives, children and adults must:

- Take a new look at the ways they think about bullying
- Understand how their actions—or inaction—can either prevent or escalate bullying behaviors
- Take responsibility and action for preventing bullying
- Learn and teach each other successful strategies and skills to prevent bullying
- Create an environment where rules of conduct are clear, children feel safe and everyone understands that bullying will not be tolerated.

What is the Impact of Bullying?

- Bullying damages the physical, social, and emotional well-being of its victims. It also hurts the children who bully as well as those who watch it happen.
- Bullying creates a climate of fear, callousness and disrespect for everyone involved.
- Bullying begins in the preschool years, peaks in early adolescence, and continues but with less frequency into the high school years. But bullying does NOT have to be a part of growing up.
- Over the past two decades, what we know about bullying—who's involved, where, when and why it occurs, and the situations that allow it to spread—has increased tremendously. This knowledge has helped researchers develop new and useful strategies that both children and adults can use to intervene effectively and better yet, prevent bullying before it ever occurs.

What Is Bullying?

Understanding what bullying looks like will help you stop it before it escalates.

Bullying is a form of emotional or physical abuse that has three defining characteristics:

- 1 Deliberate—a bully's intention is to hurt someone
- 2 Repeated—a bully often targets the same victim again and again
- 3 Power Imbalanced—a bully chooses victims he or she perceives as vulnerable

Bullying occurs in many different forms, with varying levels of severity. It may involve:

- Physical bullying—poking, pushing, hitting, kicking, beating up
- Verbal bullying—yelling, taunting, name calling, insulting, threatening to harm
- Relational bullying—excluding, spreading rumors, getting others to hurt someone

Bullying Basics

Bullying is **NOT** pre-wired, harmless, or inevitable

Bullying **IS** learned, harmful, and controllable

Bullying **SPREADS** if supported or left unchecked

Bullying **INVOLVES** everyone—bullies, victims, and bystanders

Bullying **CAN BE** effectively stopped or entirely prevented

Do your beliefs promote or prevent bullying?

Can you remember times when you were repeatedly teased, humiliated, or shut out of a group? When you were forced to do something you didn't want to do by someone you considered more powerful than you? When **YOU** intentionally hurt someone who was vulnerable, or witnessed this happening to someone else? If you are like most people, you remember... and these memories can last a lifetime.

Story Swap

Talking about bullying can help. Children may be reluctant to share their experiences because they believe their situation is unique, embarrassing, or shameful. They may think adults can't understand or help. But hearing a story about an adult's bullying experiences may move a child to reveal his or her own experiences.

- 1 Remember your own childhood story of initiating, experiencing, or witnessing bullying.
- 2 Share your story with the children in your care and explain how it made you feel then and now.
- 3 Ask children to share their own bullying story. (When in a group, have children substitute fictional names for real ones.) Acknowledge that children might feel embarrassed or afraid to recount their experience in front of others.
- 4 Discuss how the stories made them feel—to tell and to hear.
- 5 Tell children that bullying should not happen. Brainstorm suggestions for things children can do to stop or prevent bullying, using the stories they told as examples. You may want to write down their responses.

Later, after they have worked through the toolkit, return to this exercise to see how their responses may have changed.

6 Invite children to write a story about a bullying experience. Encourage young children to draw pictures. These may be the preferred options for children who are uncomfortable sharing their experiences aloud.

A culture of silence often surrounds bullying. Many children who are bullied never tell anyone.

Most bullying is NOT reported because children:

- Don't recognize it as bullying
- Are embarrassed
- Don't want to appear weak
- Believe they deserve it
- Want to belong
- Fear retaliation
- Don't know how to talk about it
- Don't have a trusted adult to confide in
- Think adults won't understand
- Think nothing can be done about it

Even if you don't observe bullying. It may be occurring. Watch for these warning signs:

- Loss of interest in activities
- Unexplained loss of personal items or clothing
- Unusually sad, moody, anxious, lonely or depressed
- Evidence of physical abuse such as bruises and scratches
- Problems with eating, sleeping, bed-wetting
- Loss of friends or changes in friends
- Headaches, stomachaches or other physical complaints
- Reluctance to participate in activities with peers
- Thoughts of suicide

Pay careful attention to these red flags, watch and listen carefully, especially if the warning signs escalate. Some children may withdraw, while others may get angry and seek revenge. Don't assume the problem will go away on its own. Invite children to talk about what is bothering them. If you find out a child is being bullied, show support, help develop a response strategy and follow up to make sure the bullying does not continue.

Who is Involved?

Bullies, Victims and Bystanders

Bullying involves three parties: bullies, victims and bystanders. Each can help make bullying stop. Bullying is learned behavior, and it can also be “unlearned” or even changed so that it’s not learned or tolerated in the first place.

How Does Bullying Work?

Bullies select and train their victims to comply to their demands. Active encouragement, passive acceptance or silence from bystanders reinforces the behavior. Bullies can be stopped when victims and bystanders apply new ways to stand up to bullying. Bullies can learn new behavior to help them make friends and get what they need by helping, not hurting others.

Victims reward bullying behavior by showing signs of intimidation and yielding control. They often avoid reporting bullying or receive support from bystanders. Victims can learn to respond assertively, gaining support from bystanders, and reporting the bullying to adults.

Bystanders can play a role in promoting or preventing bullying. They promote bullying by providing an audience for the bully, being silent, encouraging or joining in. Bystanders can neutralize or stop the bullying by coming to the aid of the victim, gaining support from other bystanders and getting help from adults.

Group Activity and Discussion: Bullying Scenarios

Materials Needed: A copy of this page for each counselor.

Divide into five groups. Assign each group a scenario to discuss. Then have each group report on their discussions. They have to determine, in the group, what submissive, hurting back and assertive would look like and then present to the larger group. If there is a safety issue in your scenario include this in your discussion. They can create a role play for each scenario, if time.

Group One: It's swim time. There is a camper who is afraid of the water and really needs an adult to work with them to get comfortable. The bully has noticed this and when the camper is standing on the shore waiting for the adult who is going to work with them that day, the bully says to the camper, "you don't even know how to swim! That's stupid! I'll teach you how to swim!" and laughs while she pushes the camper in the water.

Group Two: It's dinnertime and the bully is sitting on the bench one side of the table. The other side of the table is filled, and a camper comes over and sits on the bully's side. The bully moves over and pushes the camper off the bench and says, "you're not sitting with me. You eat funny and watching you makes me sick!"

Group Three: There is a camper who does not like to take showers. This is something that you, as the counselor, know about, and you have worked out with the parents and the camp staff that the camper will wash up at the end of the day by herself. The bully notices that this camper never showers when the rest of the bunk does and one day says to her in front of the rest of the bunk, "Why don't you take showers like the rest of us? You stink! You smell! I can't stand to be around you! It's not fair that I have to smell your stinky self."

Group Four: There are two new campers in the bunk this year. The other girls know each other from previous years and one of them has helped the new campers by explaining the routine and showing them around camp. The bully has been going to camp longer than anyone and feels that she should be the one showing the new campers around. She says to the new campers, "Don't hang out with that girl. If you want people to like you at camp, you have to hang out with me. If you hang out with her, no one will like you and you won't have any friends in camp."

Group Five: Some of the campers brought their teddy bears from home. They usually hide them in their bunk and only take them out at night. However, one day the bully was nosing around the bunk of a girl who she has taken a dislike to, and found her teddy bear. The bully shoves the teddy bear in the girl's face, and says, "You are such a baby! Only babies bring their teddy bears to camp. Here's your teddy bear you little baby! Stupid teddy bear!"

Group Activity and Discussion: Every Behavior Has a Purpose What Can You Do When...



Every behavior has a purpose. It can be challenging to know how to react when a camper is communicating through difficult behavior. These five brainstorm activities give you the opportunity to brainstorm different ways of responding in anticipation or in response to campers' behavior. Counselors should leave this session knowing that behavior is a form of communication. They should learn to be behavior detectives, working to uncover and address the root causes of their campers' behaviors, rather than reacting to the behaviors. Counselors will receive tips to help them preempt negative behaviors and become proactive in encouraging positive ones. Counselors should also walk away knowing that they are not alone, and that there are many people in camp available to support them as they develop these skills.

You can divide your staff into five groups. Give each group a copy of the behaviors listed on the next page. Assign each group a set of behaviors and discuss how they would handle a situation when a camper demonstrated a set of behaviors. At the end of the session, each group can report back to the larger group. You can also use this training to develop role-playing situations.

Brainstorm what you can do when campers display:

Group 1

Defiance
Aggression
Irritability
Anger
Fighting

Brainstorm what you can do when campers display:

Group 2

Rigid behaviors
Difficult transitions
Obsessive behavior
Perimeter walking

Brainstorm what you can do when campers display:

Group 3

Sensory issues: heat, noise, smells, dirt, sand, crowns, physical exhaustion
Eating issues

Brainstorm what you can do when campers display:

Group 4

Moodiness
Something bothering the camper but they won't talk about it
Non-participating
Kids who march to their own drummer

Brainstorm what you can do when campers display:

Group 5

Overactive
Hyperactive
Spacey
Running ahead